Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Sixth Sunday of Easter – Year A – 10th May 2026

Parish Clergy
Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215
Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)
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Thoughts on the Gospel

The gospel today is spoken on the night before Jesus' death. The disciples are anxious, and Jesus responds not with strategies but with presence. He promises that God will be closer to them *after* his departure than before it.
The Spirit becomes the inner teacher who helps us recognise Christ alive in our daily lives. When we feel abandoned, overwhelmed or spiritually flat, this passage insists that God is already within us, quietly working, strengthening, and guiding.
When we allow the Spirit to dwell in us, our actions begin to reflect the One who loves us first. This gospel passage is Jesus' promise that love, obedience and the presence of the Holy Spirit are inseparable. Obedience here is not fear-based; it's love-shaped. The heart of the passage is this: *you are never left alone*. God's own life moves toward you, dwells within you, and empowers you to love.

Lord Jesus, fill me with Your Spirit of truth and love, so that I may keep Your commandments and trust that You will never leave me orphaned.

Congratulations to the children who received their First Holy Communion in our parishes this week. May this sacrament deepen your faith and bring you closer to the heart of Christ. Heartfelt thanks to the teachers and parents / guardians who prepared the girls and boys so well to receive the sacrament. We acknowledge also the hard work and skills of those who provided decorations for the chapels. We invite you to support these young people with your prayerful encouragement, asking the Lord to guide and protect them as they continue their journey of faith. May God bless and keep them always in his care.

Rosary at the Grotto, Porthall will take place on Friday 15th May at 7.00 pm, led by Fr McCaughey. All parishioners are invited to attend.

Prayer to Our Lady of Fatima (Feast Day 13th May)

O Radiant Mother, clothed in heaven's light, you came to humble fields, where children's eyes beheld your face more gentle than the dawn, and heard your call to turn our hearts to God. Teach us the silence that can hear His voice, the courage to repent, the will to pray; wrap us within your mantle's tender shade, and guard our steps along the narrow way. Queen of the Rosary, star in the world's dark, intercede for peace where hatred burns; let mercy bloom where sorrow's roots run deep, till every soul to Christ's embrace returns.

Services of Intercession for the Dead take place in our pastoral area as follows:
St Joseph's Church, Glenmornan - Saturday 9th May at 6.00 pm
Strabane Cemetery & Camus - Sunday 10th May at 2.00 pm
Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road - Sunday 10th May at 4.30 pm
St Mary's Church, Cloughcor - Sunday 10th May at 6.30 pm.
A voluntary collection for maintenance of cemeteries will be taken up. Thank you. You are asked to co-operate with stewards. Thank you for your ongoing commitment in remembering your loved ones by visiting and maintaining their graves. *May their souls and the souls of all the faithful departed, through the mercy of God, rest in peace.*

Strabane / Lifford Half Marathon takes place on Sunday 17th May, starting at 9.30 am at the Alley Theatre and ending at Melvin Sports Complex. It is great to see this great event taking place in our town and parish community. We wish all the competitors well. Mass times next Sunday will remain the same. Please allow extra time for traffic disruption. Every good wish to all.

Anniversaries Rory Carlin, James McGranaghan, Anna McShane, John McElhinney, Edward Harkin, Michael Porter Snr, James McCormick, Margaret Tinney, Rosaleen Brolly, John Brolly, Mary McGonigle, Hugh McGeehan, David Catterson, Jim McNamee, Siobhan O'Connor, Mary Foley, Frances Porter, Sean Porter, Betty Stewart, Myra Friel. May they rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:
Leckpatrick: £1,721.54
Clonleigh: €1,902.91
Camus: £1,691.98
Thanks to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 17th May (Ascension of the Lord):
1st Reading: Acts 1:1-11
Psalm 47:47:2-3,6-7,8-9
2nd Reading Ephesians 1:17-23
Gospel Matthew 28:16-20

Saints in the Week:
Tuesday: St Nereus & St Achilleus, martyrs; St Pancras, martyr
Wednesday: Our Lady of Fatima
Thursday: St Matthias, Apostle
Friday: St Carthage, bishop
Saturday: St Brendan of Clonfert, abbot

The Little Way Novena in St Eugene's Cathedral: 9th - 17th May Theme: 'My peace consists in remaining little". The Novena begins at 7.30 pm Mass on Saturday 9th May with the Sacrament of the Sick. Devotions and talk on Sunday 10th May at 6 pm. Monday - Friday (11th - 15th May), Novena Masses at 6.30 am and 10 am each morning and an evening service with a guest speaker at 7.30 pm. Saturday, 16th May 10 am Mass for those who have died. The Novena will close on Sunday 17th May at 3 pm with blessing of roses. Everyone is welcome to St Eugene's Cathedral for this time of prayer and petition. Follow via https://www.steugenes.com/webcam.html

Derry Diocesan Pilgrimage to Knock Shrine on Saturday 6th June, in conjunction with All Ireland Rosary Rally. Buses will leave St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry at 8 am. Cost £50 (includes dinner in Knock House Hotel following Mass in the Basilica). Please contact Karen: 028 71262894 / cathedral@derrydiocese.org

The Diocese of Derry Three-Day Pilgrimage to Lough Derg will take place from Friday 24th July - Sunday 26th July 2026. Lough Derg continues to welcome people seeking prayer, peace, reflection and renewal in the midst of busy lives. A bus will travel from St Eugene's Cathedral, via Strabane and Lifford. Cost: £95 / €110 including bus transport. You are welcome, of course, to use your own means of transport. Booking form and full details available at: derrydiocese/lough-derg

Diocesan Youth Pilgrimage to Fatima Those aged 16+ are invited on pilgrimage to Fatima from 3rd - 8th August. A unique experience for young people and an opportunity to engage with their peers from around the world in a faith context.
Cost: £820. Please contact bethany.doherty@derrydiocese.org / 028 71264087.

Pilgrimage to Lourdes 3rd - 8th July 2026. Flights from Derry. Full board £899. Contact Maria at 028 81648357 or WhatsApp 07768 395038 for further details.

St Eugene's Cathedral Scholars 26/27 Open to full-time students over 16, the choral scholars sing with the cathedral choir weekly and at other special events. They receive instruction in a wide range of choral music and a stipend for their participation. Please contact maghnusmonaghan@hotmail.com Closing 11/5/26.

Murlog Parish Pilgrimage to Knock Shrine *Saturday 25th July*, leaving Murlog Chapel at 7.15 am. Cost: €50 per person, (includes coach/refreshments/meal). Please contact: James: 0858767999, Mary: 0877625237 or Bernie: 078 53272541.

Parish Bingo and Lucky Four A warm welcome to all to St Patrick's Hall every Thursday at 8 pm. Come along for some fun and excitement and slight competition.

Knock Pilgrimage to Pray for Peace in the Holy Land People from all over Ireland are invited to Knock Shrine on Saturday 16th May for a special pilgrimage to pray for peace in the Holy Land. The pilgrimage, organised by the papal charity, Aid to the Church in Need, will be led by Bishop William Shomali from Bethlehem. Bishop Shomali will offer a message of hope at 11 am, and celebrate Mass at 3 pm. All are welcome. More information at www.acnireland.org

Medjugorje Pilgrimages 2026 (45th anniversary): 24th June - 1st July. Depart Dublin - Mostar. Return Split - Dublin. €855 pps. Single room supplement: €170. For more information please contact Ursula O Faodhagain, Castlefin 0872960562.

Lough Derg Day Retreats (guided prayer & reflection) **May** 12,17,23,25, **August** 18,22,23,29,31, **Sept** 5,6,9,12,15,19,20. Adm: €50. Booking essential.
3 Day Pilgrimages in tradition of prayer, fasting & vigil: May 29th-August 15th. Adm: €85. Booking advised. Contact +353 (0) 719861518 or info@loughderg.org

Monthly Mass in Honour of Sr Clare Crockett will be celebrated today (Sunday) at 7 pm in the Carmelite Retreat Centre, Termonbacca, Derry. All welcome.

Catholic School Leadership Development Opportunities Derry Diocesan Catechetical Centre, in partnership with St Mary's University, Twickenham, offers a number of avenues for the professional development and spiritual formation of Catholic school leaders. The full Masters in Catholic School Leadership is a post graduate degree dedicated to the professional development and spiritual formation of Catholic school leaders. A post graduate certificate and diploma are also offered. A great opportunity for those currently in leadership roles and those who aspire to, or have an interest in, leadership roles within the Catholic school system. Please contact the Catechetical Centre: 004428 71264087 or tferry@derrydiocese.org to register for any of the options in September 2026, to attend an online information session on 8th June at 4 pm, or require information.

Ladies' Weekend Retreat, entitled 'In the Upper Room with Mary', led by Sisters from the Apostles of the Sacred Heart of Jesus (Waterford) takes place in Termonbacca, Derry from Friday 22nd - Sunday 24th May. Cost: including accommodation is £90. Please contact Aoife: 02871262512 or termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

Marriage Preparation Course Places still available on June 19th/20th course in Everglades Hotel, Derry. Book at www.accordni.com If getting married in 2026, please consider booking as Accord Derry aren't facilitating courses in July/August.

Encounter Weekend Donegal, Radisson Blu, Letterkenny. Fri 5th June 6pm-10.30 pm; Sat 6th June 9 am - 10.30 pm. Experience the presence of God through the celebration of the sacraments, Spirit-led worship, inspiring talks, healing service, and fellowship. Come and be refreshed and empowered by the Holy Spirit and learn from the saints how to live the lifestyle God intended you to live. Bookings at https://encounterschoolofministrydoneg.regfox.com/encounter-conference-donegal For more information, email donegal@encounterschool.org

A Silent Retreat preached by Fr Kilian Byrne, Foyer of Charity takes place at Carmelite Retreat Centre, Termonbacca, Derry from 13th - 19th July. Theme: "If you but knew the gift of God...". Cost: £395 / €450 full board. Contact Helen: 00353 86 1678027 / hellywilliams@gmail.com Visit: www.foyerofcharity.ie A privileged time to come away from noise and distractions, and listen to the Spirit of God - who is love. Silence, prayer, teachings and liturgy of the Church.

Strabane Chorale, with guest German choir, Chor Levantate, will perform a concert to suit all tastes in St Mary's Church, Melmount on Sunday 31st May at 5 pm. Retiring collection for choir and church funds. Everyone welcome.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: 4.30 pm; Sunday: 11.00 am

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: 12.15 pm

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: 6.30 pm; Sunday: 9.45 am

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: 8.30 am (10th May - alternate Sundays)

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: 8.30 am (17th May - alternate Sundays)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday:	7.45 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road
	10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford
Tuesday:	10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane
Wednesday:	10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford
	12.00 noon: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road
Thursday:	10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane
Friday:	7.45 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road
	10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, **27 Butcher St, Strabane** covers all 3 parishes**.** **Office hours:** Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am - 12.30 pm. Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101,Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.